

ANDREAS SOCHOPOULOS

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EDUCATION

The University of Edinburgh, UK

September 2023 - Present

PhD in Robot Learning (*Honda Research Institute EU funded studentship*)

Advisors: Sethu Vijayakumar (UoE), Michael Gienger (HRI-EU)

Research topic: *Fast and self-improving robot policies using diffusion and flow models for manipulation.*

Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AUTh), Greece

September 2016 - October 2022

Diploma in Electrical and Computer Engineering (5-year degree)

Average Grade: **9.08/10** ("Excellent", 3rd highest grade)

Advisor: Georgios Rovithakis

Thesis Title: *Prescribed performance torque control with obstacles for uncertain robot dynamics.*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Honda Research Institute EU (HRI-EU)

September 2023 - Present

Research Collaborator

Offenbach, Germany

Joint research on imitation learning for manipulation and annual research visits for robot deployments.

University of Tokyo

June 2025 - August 2025

Visiting Researcher

Tokyo, Japan

Researched point-cloud generation using diffusion models.

Italian Institute of Technology (IIT) - Advanced Robotics

April 2022 - April 2023

Research Assistant

Genoa, Italy

Developed human activity recognition and adaptive assistance systems for assistive robots.

WORK EXPERIENCE

CERN

February 2021 - April 2022

Software Engineer

Geneva, Switzerland

Built and maintained monitoring software running in the control room of the CMS detector and developed embedded applications for measuring equipment related safety signals.

KENOTOM P.C.

July 2020 - September 2020

Software Engineering Intern

Thessaloniki, Greece

Worked on automotive automation software and PID controller tuning software.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant in Applied Machine Learning

September 2025 - Present

The University of Edinburgh

Tutor in Machine Learning and Pattern Recognition

September 2024 - January 2025

The University of Edinburgh

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Sochopoulos, A., Whitamner, E., Tsagkas, N., Moura, J., Gienger, M., and Vijayakumar, S. “Optimal Transport Q-Learning for Flow Policy Steering and Acceleration.” **Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)**, 2026.

Tsagkas, N., **Sochopoulos, A.**, Danier, D., Vijayakumar, S., Lu, C. X., Mac Aodha, O., and Kouris, A. “Decoupling the Declarative from the Procedural in Vision-Language-Action Models.” arXiv preprint, 2026.

Sochopoulos, A., Malkin, N., Tsagkas, N., Moura, J., Gienger, M., and Vijayakumar, S. “Fast Flow-based Visuomotor Policies via Conditional Optimal Transport Couplings.” **Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)**, 2025.

Tsagkas, N., **Sochopoulos, A.**, Danier, D., Vijayakumar, S., Lu, C. X., Mac Aodha, O. “Attentive Feature Aggregation or: How Policies Learn to Stop Worrying about Robustness and Attend to Task-Relevant Visual Cues” **International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)**, 2025.

Sochopoulos, A., Gienger, M., and Vijayakumar, S. “Learning Deep Dynamical Systems Using Stable Neural ODEs.” **International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)**, 2024.

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

A.G. Leventis Foundation PhD scholarship (re-awarded)	2025
A.G. Leventis Foundation PhD scholarship	2024

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C++, C, Embedded C, ARM Cortex M0-M4 Assembly, Go
Robots I worked with: KUKA iiwa LBR, Kinova Gen3 7DoF
Languages: Greek (native), English (fluent), German (basic)